



UNIVERSITY OF MARYLAND, COLLEGE PARK

User-Centered Design

INST 362 – 3 credit hours

Spring 2021 Syllabus

Course Dates: Jan. 27, 2021 - May. 19, 2021

[Semester Schedule for UMD](#)

Course Times: Modules begin on Wednesdays with the release of a pre-recorded lecture.

Group work sessions are synchronous on Wednesdays, Thursdays or Fridays depending on your group.

Class format: Asynchronous lectures and class participation (discussion board) and synchronous group working sessions

Professor: Dr Victoria Van Hyning (she/her)

Email: vvh@umd.edu

Preferred communication: Canvas messaging system, email, office hours

Office Hours: 2pm-3pm Tuesdays (see end of syllabus for the recurring Zoom information)

Land Acknowledgement

Every community owes its existence and vitality to generations from around the world who contribute their hopes, dreams, and energy to their society. Some were brought to America against their will, some were drawn to leave their distant homes in hope of a better life, and some have lived on the land where UMD College Park stands for more generations than can be counted. UMD stands on the ancestral lands of the Piscataway People, who were among the first in the Western Hemisphere to encounter European colonists. We pay respects to their elders past and present. Please take a moment to consider the many legacies of violence, displacement, migration, and settlement that bring us together virtually or in person as a university community, and the opportunities to learn about and acknowledge the complex forces that govern all our lives.

Instructional Team and Core Responsibilities

Professor Victoria Van Hyning (she/her/hers) will provide lectures, guidance on your group work, grade assignments, and meet with any student needing ADS support or academic assistance during the semester.

Please use her office hours for general questions and request a 1-1 meeting for personal issues including mental or physical health issues that are affecting your work.

Grader Alea Oakman aoakman@umd.edu will be assisting Professor Van Hying with grading student assignments and group work. She will host weekly studio sessions on **Wednesdays 6pm-8pm ET** (starting week 3) .

UTAs will grade weekly discussion posts using the 0-1-2 grading rubric, and will host synchronous studio sessions on different days and times to support your group projects, starting in week 3.

- **Mengyun "Zoe" Liu** mliu1211@terpmail.umd.edu Studio sessions **Thursdays 8am-10am ET** (starting week 3)
- **Seungjoo "Josh" Hong** sjhong@terpmail.umd.edu. Studio sessions **Fridays 2pm-4pm ET** (starting week 3)
- **Tanishq Kaushik** tkaushik@terpmail.umd.edu. Studio sessions **Thursdays 8am-10am ET** (starting week 3)

Course Description

Please note: This syllabus--particularly the weekly assignments posted on ELMS--is subject to change with advance notice. Prof. V will send you an announcement via ELMS at least 1 week before changing the syllabus or an assignment.

Description from Testudo: "Introduction to human-computer interaction (HCI), with a focus on how HCI connects psychology, information systems, computer science, and human factors. User-centered design and user interface implementation methods discussed include identifying user needs, understanding user behaviors, envisioning interfaces, and utilizing prototyping tools, with an emphasis on incorporating people in the design process from initial field observations to summative usability testing."

Prerequisite: 1 course with a minimum grade of C- from (INST201, INST301); and minimum grade of C- in INST326; and minimum grade of C- in PSYC100.

Restriction: Must be in the Information Science program.

Course Objectives

After successfully completing this course you will be able to:

- Articulate important historical, current and emerging trends, critical issues, and theoretical underpinnings of User Experience design.
- Articulate and apply major user experience research methods, such as user interviews, surveys, contextual analysis, diary studies, storyboarding, experience design, persona development, task description, sketching, video scenarios, use cases, and competitive analysis.
- Demonstrate the appropriate use of UX design artifacts such as flow diagrams, wire-framing, and paper prototypes.

- Apply data from UX evaluations to improve interfaces and interactive design through an iterative design process.
- Design and critically evaluate existing designs for users from diverse backgrounds with varying needs, applying anti-racist perspectives to ensure usability needs are met for all users.

Course structure for our section

WEEK B	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
	Group Work Due (Week A)	Discussion Response Due (Week A)	Studio groups 7-9	Studio groups 4-6	Studio groups 1-3		Discussion Reflection due
		Lecture Posted Online (Week B) -- Complete before your studio time!					Individual Assignment Due
		Readings Posted					
WEEK C	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
	Group Work Due (Week B)	Discussion Response Due (Week B)	Studio groups 7-9	Studio groups 4-6	Studio groups 1-3		Discussion Reflection due
		Lecture Posted Online (Week C) -- Complete before your studio time!					Individual Assignment Due
		Readings Posted					

This section of 362 is held **asynchronously online** and made up of three main components.

1. **Lectures** will generally be pre-recorded and released on **Tuesdays** ~~Wednesdays~~. This class is fully online and asynchronous, which is designed to offer significant flexibility. All weekly lectures are available through Panopto in ELMS. **When we begin group work in week 3 you should start trying to watch your lectures before your studio time as these will often tie in to your studio work directly.** Panopto tracks how much of each video a student has watched, and we will use this information to calculate part of your class participation grade. If you haven't watched the video by the end of the module or week, this will be counted as an absence from class. Repeated absences throughout the semester will severely limit your participation potential.

Sometimes I will provide you with alternative lecture opportunities, for example outside speakers, and lecture recordings by colleagues teaching synchronous 362 classes this semester. Each week you will complete a written assignment to ensure your engagement with and comprehension of lectures and the assigned reading, podcasts or videos. When we have external speakers there will be an option to watch in real time and ask questions at the end. Because we're a large group and these sessions will be open to other classes, you don't need to have your video on, and we'll use the chat function to ask questions. There will usually be a short quiz about the lecture posted a day after. The outside speakers will be recorded so that anyone who couldn't watch in real time will be able to catch up.

2. **Small group discussion boards:** Most weeks you will have assigned readings, videos, or podcasts about which to write short reflection pieces to share with a discussion group of 8-10 classmates via ELMS (groups are created by Prof. Van Hying). This format is in lieu of real-time class lectures and discussions, **and is in addition to your weekly assignments** based on the same readings/videos/podcasts. We will begin discussions in week 1, and then the groups will change in week 3 when we have established groups for our design projects.

Because we are working asynchronously, the discussion boards are a vital part of the class. They are intended to help you think more deeply about the material you have read, and give you the opportunity to express your ideas to other people in a clear, grammatically correct, logical way. Discussion posts are how you will raise questions about the material you have read, and how you will find out if others reacted differently than you did. **To receive full credit**, your reflection posts must include 1-2 quotations from the assigned materials, and a 100-200 word response to these readings. Your response should be a critical analysis that clearly links to the materials and not just some random thoughts about design. You can draw on your personal experience from work, school, and life to inform your analysis and get your point across. Grammar, punctuation, and clarity of writing will also be taken into account (see separate rubric below for guidance).

The **100-200 word reflection piece** with two quotations is due on your group's discussion board thread on ELMS by **Sunday 11:59pm Eastern Time each week**. Your **response** to someone else's reflection is due by **11:59pm Eastern Time on Tuesdays**. Feel free to post on multiple threads if you like! More conversation is great. **Again, these posts will be graded as your class participation**, and are an important way for the instructional team and me to make sure that you understand the material and are making the progress you need to both to succeed in this course and in this work once you leave UMD. (See the "Grading Structure and Assignments" for more about the rubric.)

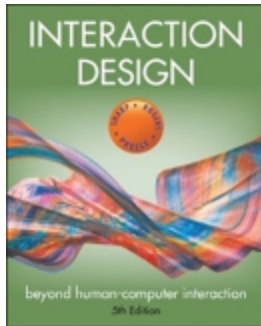
3. **Synchronous group work** aka **studio sections** will begin in week 3 of this course after the add/drop period has passed and you've gotten familiar with some basic concepts of user-centered design. Your group collaboration will result in a final project that constitutes 30% of your grade. Studio will take place via Discord on Wednesdays 6pm-8pm, Thursdays 8am-10am, and Fridays 2pm-4pm and each team of 5 will commit showing up every week at the same time to undertake their collaboration. You will fill out a survey signup sheet in the first week of class to choose a recurring time and date that you can make to meet with your collaborators. Prof. V will drop in sometimes, but Alea, Tanishq, Josh, and Mengyun will be your leaders and support you in studio sessions. **Your group work is a major portion of your grade in this class and your opportunity to learn new things that should serve you really well in your future endeavors, whatever field you enter.**

Excused Absences. If you have to miss your section due to an illness or similar reason, contact your UTA and your team **6 or more hours** before the session begins, if at all possible. Contacting your TA will help you avoid impacting your participation grade, and contacting your team will help you and them figure out what you need to do to make up for your absence.

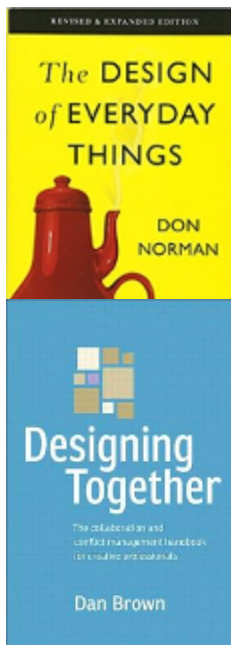
* Lectures will cover course material, but you'll only develop a deep understanding of the material for tests, assignments, projects, and small group discussions if you complete the assigned readings and activities. You are responsible for keeping up with assignments per the schedule in the syllabus and being prepared for asynchronous group discussions and studio time.

Key texts, technology and tools

All chapters uploaded to ELMS



Interaction Design: Beyond Human-Computer Interaction (5th edition) by Sharp, Rogers, & Preece. Amazon link [here](#). Cool accompanying resources are available [here](#).

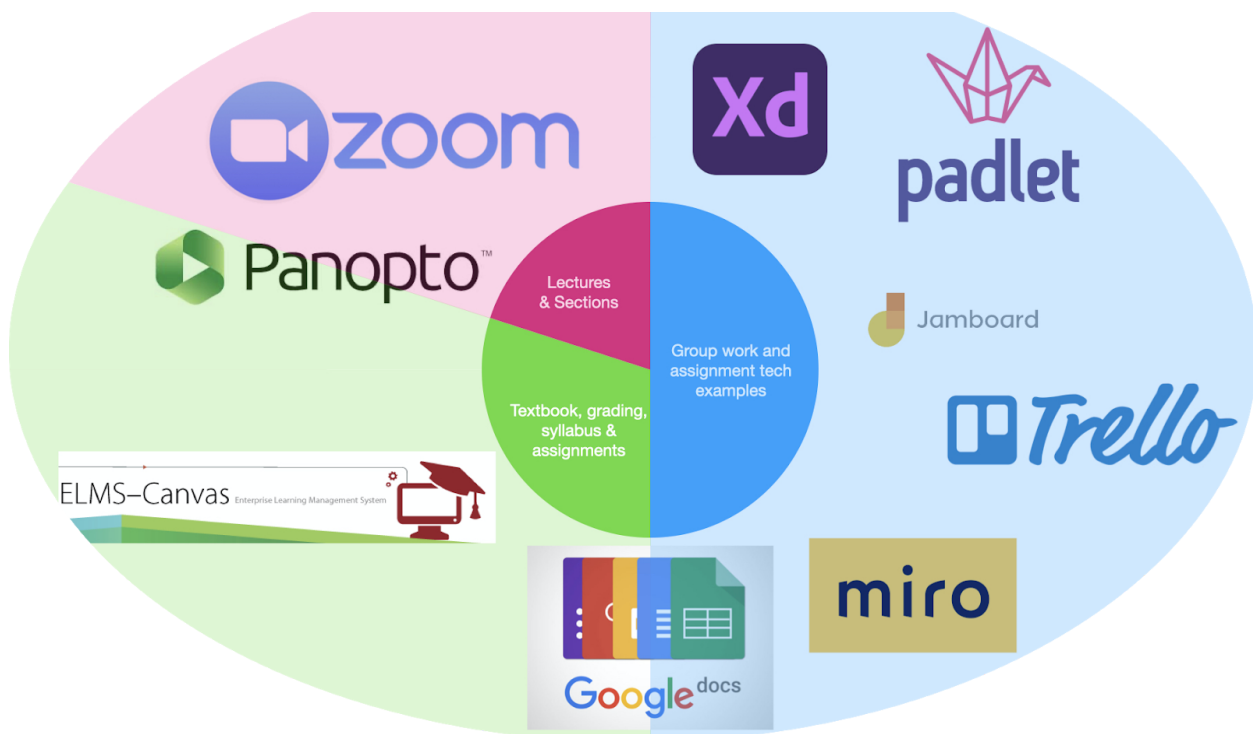


The Design of Everyday Things: Revised and expanded edition
Norman, D.A. (2013)

Brown, D. M. (2013). *Designing together: The collaboration and conflict management handbook for creative professionals*. Pearson Education.

There will be other readings, videos, and podcasts from time to time, and all will be linked directly from ELMS.

Tools



We'll use a combination of online tools to facilitate the remote class and teamwork experience. Some tools will be familiar to you, and others might be new. The majority of these tools will be helpful beyond the classroom, for instance to conduct remote user research and collaborate with business colleagues. We're using the tools partly because they offer different strengths to help us complete our work together this semester, and partly because you'll be able to use them in your work in the future. Even once we're out of the pandemic, remote work and multi time zone/country collaboration isn't going anywhere!

ELMS-Canvas: ELMS will be used to access and submit individual assignments (such as readings), as well as reminders for completing team assignments (although those assignments will be 'submitted' in Google Drive). It is also where our weekly group discussions will take place (Sunday and Tuesday posts). I will also send out any announcements via Canvas as well.

Discord: Discord was originally designed as a platform to connect gamers, but it's useful for education and team collaboration too. It's a bit like Slack, Microsoft Teams, and HipChat, which you might encounter in your workplace in future. All these tools enable you to chat, video and voice conference, and are vital to keeping remote teams connected and enabling collaboration. They can be fun, too! But remember, this is an extension of our learning space not a dorm space or informal hang, so keep it respectful and professional. Your behavior in this space is as important as your behavior in person and over email. In other words--don't be a jerk, especially not when there's a digital record of it. It will bite you in the tush eventually/get you into serious trouble with me and the university. You may join our discord server by clicking on the following link: <https://discord.gg/gvD7vEp5V9>. After you join the server, it will be available on your discord account.

Google Drive: Google Drive is where all your team work will take place, and how your team will submit group assignments. In Google Drive, you'll write up your design reports, store useful information for your small group,

and receive feedback from the Instructional Team. Once each team has chosen their name, the Instructional Team will create a folder for your group and invite you to it. **The history feature on Google Docs is one of the ways we will track contributions from each team member--every contribution can be linked to a specific person, time and date, which means your labor will be visible.**

Design and Collaboration Tools: In addition to Google Drive we'll be using a wide variety of tools for individual and group assignments, including Miro, Trello, Jamboard and others, as a way to get you familiar with the various tech used in industry, and to assist you in your design work. These tools will be introduced as we go along via lectures and instructional videos from YouTube etc.

Semester Outline

This outline is just to give you an idea of how the semester will be laid out - the details for each week are in ELMS with appropriate deadlines, writing prompts and rubrics.

	Lecture dates (Wednesdays)	Theme	Sunday Deadline	Tuesday Deadline
Week 1	1/27/2021	A brief introduction to User-Centered Design and our syllabus/ELMS	Syllabus/ELMS survey; introduce yourself post (ELMS); Complete additional survey to determine; group work; Complete first reading and written assignment; Discussion forum reflection post	Discussion forum response post; Good & Bad Design Project I
Week 2	2/3/2021	User-Centered Design	Readings, individual homework; Discussion forum reflection post	Good & Bad Design Project II; Discussion forum response post
Week 3	2/10/2021	Iterating and Prototyping	Readings; individual assignment; Discussion reflection post	Good & Bad Design Project III; Discussion forum response post

Week 4	2/17/2021	Teams and Teamwork	Readings; individual assignment; Discussion reflection post	Group Design Cycle Experience Project I; Discussion forum response post
Week 5	2/24/2021	Design Cycle Experience introduction	Readings; individual assignment; Discussion reflection post	Group Design Cycle Experience Project II brainstorming meeting; Discussion forum response post
Week 6	3/3/2021	Contextual Inquiry	Readings; individual assignment; Discussion reflection post	Group Design Cycle Experience Project III; Discussion forum response post
Week 7	3/10/2021	Data Analysis and Interpretation	Readings; individual assignment; Discussion reflection post	Group Design Cycle Experience Project IV; Discussion forum response post
	3/17/2021	SPRING BREAK!		
Week 8	3/24/2021	Personas, Scenarios, and Users	Readings; individual assignment; Discussion reflection post	Group Design Cycle Experience Project V; Discussion forum response post
Week 9	3/31/2021	User-Testing Prototypes	Readings; individual assignment; Discussion reflection post	Group Design Cycle Experience Project VI; Discussion forum response post
Week 10	4/7/2021	Iterating Prototypes I	Readings; individual assignment; Discussion reflection post	Group Design Cycle Experience Project VII; Discussion forum response post
Week 11	4/14/2021	Iterating Prototypes II	Readings; individual assignment; Discussion reflection post	Group Design Cycle Experience Project VIII; Discussion forum response post

Week 12	4/21/2021	Iterating Prototypes III	Readings; individual assignment; Discussion reflection post	Group Design Cycle Experience Project IX; Discussion forum response post
Week 13	4/28/2021	Delivering Products	Readings; individual assignment; Discussion reflection post	Group Design Cycle Experience Project X; Discussion forum response post
Week 14+	5/5/2021	Presentations and Final Prototypes	Readings; individual assignment; Discussion reflection post	Group Design Cycle Experience Project final presentations; Discussion forum response post

Grading Structure and Assignments

Assignment	Points available	Percent of Final Grade
Individual written assignments about weekly reading/listening/watching & week 1 syllabus annotation (10 pts each) See ELMS for details	140	20%
Watching weekly lectures (one will be posted most weeks). + Weekly small group discussion board reflection and response posts equivalent to class attendance and participation (2 pts/week + 1 bonus post in week 1) See syllabus and ELMS for details. Failure to watch the lecture will lead to a reduction of one point per week and will have a significant impact on your grade.	30	25%
Section/studio Participation (10 pts/11 studio sections). Weekly grades based on attendance and engagement (5 pts), and documenting and submitting your weekly assignments as a group (5 pts). Regular peer reviews 30 points (10 pts/3 times during semester). Rubrics for peer review and a Google Survey to log responses will be provided via ELMS and linked in Discord.	140	20%
Good and Bad Design Project See ELMS for details	30	5%
Team Project: Design Cycle Experience assignments weeks 3-14. See below	100	30%

Total	488	100%
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For the weekly individual assignments, 2 points will be awarded for submitting something to the canvas, and an additional 0, 2, or 4 points will be awarded based on your answers for each of the two questions. A perfect score is equal to 10 points.

Weekly individual written assignments posted in ELMS	Evaluation
The post completely answers the question in an original 100-200(ish) word response. The student demonstrates clear understanding of the course materials and is able to use their knowledge to inform their own ideas. The student communicates clearly and uses 1-2 examples to back up their claims	2 pts
The student does not support their claim with examples, or provides unrelated material. The post is too short, does not engage directly with the material, or is a simple reiteration of the material.	1 pts
The student does not post anything, or posts something completely unrelated to the reading. Responses with harassing, derogatory, or hateful language will also get no points.	0 pts

Weekly Reflection & Response Rubric scale of 0-1-2 graded by UTAs on the following basis	Evaluation
The Reflection post includes 1-2 substantive quotations from the assigned readings, podcasts or videos and an original 100-200-ish word analysis that clearly engages with the materials. The student introduces their own ideas and writes clearly, often using correct grammar and punctuation. The student then carefully and respectfully responds to at least one classmate's post. Answers that are really long will not receive extra points, so keep it short, sweet, and coherent.	2pts
The Reflection post is missing a quotation at the top or presents material that is off-topic. The post is too short, does not engage directly with the materials or is a simple reiteration of the material. Student responds to classmates with simple agree/disagree type statements or a simple "lol."	1 pts
Student does not post anything, or posts something so incoherent that the tie to the set material can't be seen by the grader. Posts with any harassing, derogatory or hateful language will get no points.	0 pts

Group studio attendance, participation and weekly assignments (starting week 3)	Evaluation
Weekly attendance and engagement. Each individual student will receive a mark out of 5 points for each studio session. Full marks awarded if the student is in the Discord channel with their team with the TAs take attendance; there is evidence of each person contributing to the discussion and to the group work submitted for that week. Weekly group assignments should demonstrate each individual's input to the shared Google Design Doc/Miro board or other relevant tool used for the assignment.	5 pts

Weekly group assignments, whether these are the exploration of values on Miro, writing a team contract, conducting interviews, sketching or making prototypes--all submissions should clearly follow the weekly assignment steps provided in ELMS, and if submitted within the team's design document should contain clear writing that allows the grader to understand the submission. The grader should not have to struggle to understand or interpret how your submission meets the weekly brief as described by Prof. Van Hyning on ELMS.	5 pts
Total available for each week	10 pts

*Remember, these grades will be taken together with your peer review marks.

Good and Bad Design Project (5% of final grade)

This project is individual, and involves identifying good and bad design in your life, then prototyping a better version of a badly designed product. It will take place over the first three weeks, to let folks settle into the semester and this class before starting a team-based project.

Design Cycle Experience Project (30% of final grade)

This project is team-based, like most design work in industry. Your team will focus on identifying a problem, then prototyping, testing, and iterating towards a solution to that problem. The final presentation will involve sharing the entire design process that led to your final prototype.

Each team member will have a specific role in the weekly team meetings (these roles only cover one aspect of your contribution to the team work, and do not completely define the work you'll do for the team project):

- **Project Manager:** The PM will check over and then submit the group's weekly assignments.
- **Tech Support:** Will answer questions from teammates about tech issues such as logging into Discord, using collaborative tools such as Trello and Miro, and generally facilitate group communication/collaboration.
- **Recorder:** Responsible for tracking the project progress using Google Docs or another tool of the team's choosing, such as Miro or Trello. Takes notes during studio session via Google Docs to share with the team and the instructors
- **Value Leader:** This person will track adherence to established Team Values and Team Contract developed in weeks 3-4 as a way to maintain group cohesion, for example by identifying challenges and opportunities to overcome conflict.
- **Outreach coordinator:** This person will organize and consolidate the information about the interviews for the group project testing phase (each team member will conduct interviews), and will coordinate the details of the group's final presentation.

Team Values

Each team will develop their own Team Values document, including measurable attributes, which will constitute the **team contract**. Each member's adherence to those values during their team projects will determine their grade for the project. There are three values that each team is required to have as a foundation, but each team can add their own values to the list.

- Be dependable--if you say you are going to do something, get it done. If you're struggling, ask for help! Dependability isn't having all the answers, it's about knowing when to ask for help and resources to meet your goals.
- Embrace a growth mentality. You're here to learn new things. How can you be open to that learning process now, and lay a foundation for growth for the rest of your life? This is a diverse group from all over the world, with different strengths and weaknesses. What can we all learn from each other?
- Be respectful of one another, welcoming and open-minded to new ideas.

Although these values are defined as a team, each individual member will be measured (and graded) individually by their peers.

Special Topics and Extra Credit

The field of user-centered design is informed by, and is useful to, a wide range of other disciplines and practices. You can receive up to 5 points extra credit (1 point per each external talk; added to your final grade) for attending/watching certain presentations outside of class and filling out short Extra Credit quizzes on ELMS. These include:

- The iSchool's HCI Lab's Brown Bag Speaker Series: <https://hcil.umd.edu/bbl-speaker-series/>
- Guest Lectures at other INST 362 classes this semester (Professor Surla; Prof. Williams-Pierce) - I will share the relevant links as these arise.
- Other design-oriented talks - if you attend or watch a recorded talk other than the ones listed above, you'll be asked to fill out a question explaining why that talk was relevant to design in your *Extra Credit* quiz.

To get the extra credit, the presentations must be from this semester - if you can't attend them synchronously, some of them (particularly the HCI Speaker Series) will be recorded, and you can receive credit by watching those recordings. You can always work ahead for these extra credits, to make sure you get them all. However, as the semester progresses, about one extra credit opportunity will 'expire' each month. So don't try to cram them all into the final week of the semester, because you won't be able to!

General UMD grade policies and course related policies

UMD has a website where you can learn more about course policies including the campus-wide honor system. <http://www.ugst.umd.edu/courserelatedpolicies.html> I take the truth and each person honestly doing their own work very seriously. Please don't disappoint me by cheating. I would much rather you tell me if you're having an issue that prevents you doing your work than that you find a way to cheat or recycle someone else's work. Failing to deliver on an assignment is a learning opportunity, and it might be a sign that there's a lot of stress in your life. Let's deal with the real problem rather than letting an infraction take center stage. Trust me, it will be more fun to tell me the truth.

98-100 A+	87-89 B+	77-79 C+	67-69 D+	0-59 F
93-97 A	83-86 B	73-76 C	63-66 D	
90-92 A-	80-82 B-	70-72 C-	60-62 D-	

A+ A A-	Excellent mastery of subject
B+ B B-	Good mastery of subject
C+ C C-	Acceptable mastery of subject
D+ D D-	Borderline understanding of subject
F	Failure
I	Incomplete (Final Grades Only)
J	Judicial—student has been referred for a judicial review. No grade is posted and the "judicial review" is placed in the system. After the review is complete, the Honor Council panel will either submit the grade or ask the instructor to submit the grade earned (Final Grades Only). Faculty are never allowed to enter the XF grade themselves.
S	Satisfactory
U	Unsatisfactory (Early Warning Grades Only)
Z	Never Attended—the grade posts as an "F" and a note indicating that the student never attended the course is placed in the system.
XF	Failure for academic dishonesty

* Table copied from <https://tltc.umd.edu/grading>

Late assignments

Prof Van Hyning will grant extensions if there's a good reason like a medical emergency, bereavement or similarly difficult personal circumstances. If you need to miss a studio session or hand in an assignment late, please give as much notice as possible. Of course in a real emergency this is not always possible. For any other unexplained absence or missing work, the following rules will be applied:

Day 1: 15% deduction

Days 2 and 3: Additional 10% daily

Not accepted after 3 days

My Expectations of You

Dialogue, Not Debate: You all share a responsibility for the course's learning environment. Creating a cohesive learning community requires learners to support and assist each other. To craft an open and interactive online learning environment, communication has to be conducted in a professional and courteous manner at all times, guided by common sense, collegiality and an emphasis on *dialogue* with each other, not debate. You can use GIPHS, acronyms such as TIL (Today I Learned), and emojis to add *tone* to your text communications with your fellow students on Discord, Google Docs and the ELMS discussion board, but keep it PG-13.

In particular, with a diversity of perspectives and experience, we may find ourselves in disagreement and/or debate with one another. As such, it is important that we agree to conduct ourselves in a professional manner and that we work together to foster and preserve a virtual classroom environment in which we can respectfully discuss and deliberate controversial questions. In particular, we should all seek to engage in [dialogue, not debate](#).

I encourage you to confidently exercise your right to free speech—bearing in mind, of course, that you will be expected to craft and defend arguments that support your position. Keep in mind, that free speech has its limit and this course is not the space for hate speech, harassment, and derogatory language. I will make every reasonable attempt to create an atmosphere in which each student feels comfortable voicing their argument without fear of being personally attacked, mocked, demeaned, or devalued.

Any behavior (including harassment, sexual harassment, and racially and/or culturally derogatory language) that threatens this atmosphere will not be tolerated. Please alert me immediately if you feel threatened, dismissed, or silenced at any point during our semester together and/or if your engagement in discussion has been in some way hindered by the learning environment.

The University of Maryland recognizes the importance of a diverse student body, and we are committed to fostering inclusive and equitable classroom environments. I invite you, if you wish, to tell us how you want to be referred to both in terms of your name (pronunciation and preferred name) and your pronouns (he/him, she/her, they/them, etc.). NameCoach Roster is enabled in ELMS. You can use this to record a pronunciation of your name, or write a phonetic equivalent of it to help the Instructional Team and other students pronounce your name correctly. Both your pronouns and NameCoach can be edited from your ELMS User Profile: Account > Profile, then Edit Profile for pronouns, and NameCoach for pronunciation.

Multi-Tasking is a myth: Refrain from using your cellphone or laptop during studio or live lectures for anything other than specified activities. If you must take a call or attend to an urgent email, indicate to your fellow students and others that you are away from your desk, and return to class when you can fully participate again. *Figure out what you need to do to stay focused in class, whether that's by closing all the browsers and programs that don't directly pertain to the course, setting up a post-it note reminder to yourself to STAY FOCUSED, etc. Learning how to design your work-space to help you stay focused will be a valuable skill long after this semester is over.*

Resources & Accommodations

Accessibility and Disability Services

If you have an accommodation letter, share it with Professor Van Hyning asap and email her in week 1 or 2 to find a time to discuss your needs.

The University of Maryland is committed to creating and maintaining a welcoming and inclusive educational, working, and living environment for people of all abilities. The University of Maryland is also committed to the principle that no qualified individual with a disability shall, on the basis of disability, be excluded from participation in or be denied the benefits of the services, programs, or activities of the University, or be subjected to discrimination. The **Accessibility & Disability Service (ADS)** provides reasonable accommodations to qualified individuals to provide equal access to services, programs and activities. ADS cannot assist retroactively, so it is generally best to request accommodations several weeks before the semester begins or as soon as a disability becomes known. Any student who needs accommodations should contact me as soon as possible so that I have sufficient time to make arrangements.

For assistance in obtaining an accommodation, contact Accessibility and Disability Service at 301-314-7682, or email them at adsfrontdesk@umd.edu. Information about **sharing your accommodations with instructors, note taking assistance** and more is available from the **Counseling Center**.

Student Resources and Services

Taking personal responsibility for your own learning means acknowledging when your performance does not match your goals and doing something about it. I hope you will come talk to me during office hours or at a specifically arranged time initiated by you so that I can help you find the right approach to success in this course. I encourage you to visit **UMD's Student Academic Support Services website** to learn more about the wide range of campus resources available to you.

In particular, everyone can use some help sharpening their communication skills (and improving their grade) by visiting **UMD's Writing Center** and schedule an appointment with the campus Writing Center.

You should also know there are a wide range of resources to support you with whatever you might need (**UMD's Student Resources and Services website** may help). If you feel it would be helpful to have someone to talk to, visit **UMD's Counseling Center** or **one of the many other mental health resources on campus**.

Basic Needs Security

If you have difficulty affording groceries or accessing sufficient food to eat every day, or lack a safe and stable place to live, please visit **UMD's Division of Student Affairs website** for information about resources the campus offers you and let me know if I can help in any way.

Course Evaluation

Please submit a course evaluation through CourseEvalUM in order to help faculty and administrators improve teaching and learning at Maryland. All information submitted to CourseEvalUM is confidential. Campus will notify you when CourseEvalUM is open for you to complete your evaluations for fall semester courses. Please go directly to the **Course Eval UM website** to complete your evaluations. By completing all of your evaluations each semester, you will have the privilege of accessing through Testudo, the evaluation reports for the thousands of courses for which 70% or more students submitted their evaluations.

Prof Van Hyning's Office Hours

What are office hours really for? It might be intimidating to go to office hours, but there's a lot to be gained. You can ask about material you didn't understand, raise concerns and questions or just have a chance to get to know me and your fellow students better. Most weeks I'll share a quick tip or lesson related to our learning goals for the week. You can come prepared with a question or just turn up to turn up.

Time: 2-3pm ET Tuesdays.

Join Zoom Meeting

This is a recurring meeting and this link will work each time

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Tech Appendix

Various tech resources will be placed here as the Instructional Team gets educational accounts for various tools.

Want to see a list of various tools used in industry and education curated by professors in the iSchool? Click [HERE!](#)